

Reading Labels Pt. 2

- **PRODUCE**
 - Choose foods WITHOUT labels as often as possible
 - Go for a variety of colors – taste the rainbow!
 - Choose organic when possible, to minimize pesticide exposure
- **"HEALTH" FOODS AND ORGANIC FOODS**
 - Organic/Non-GMO/Vegan/Keto foods are NOT necessarily healthier – make sure to still read the label
 - Organic foods DO typically contain fewer pesticides, preservatives, growth hormones, etc. and are richer in certain nutrients
 - Avoid protein/energy bars with soluble fiber, tons of ingredients that aren't food
 - Look for ingredients you mostly recognize (it's ok if there's some you don't)
 - Tofu – always buy organic and non-gmo
- **CANNED GOODS**
 - Look for organic when possible, always wash canned beans/legumes
 - Avoid fruits canned in syrups (opt for fruits packed in water instead)
- **BREADS & CEREALS**
 - Target of 2 grams of fiber per 1 oz slice bread
 - Sprouted and whole grain are good choices
 - White breads can be helpful around exercise (easy to digest)
 - Look for less than 10-15 g sugar per serving of cereal
 - Look for at least 3 g fiber and 5 g protein per serving of cereal
- **ANIMAL PROTEIN**
 - Eggs – may be slightly more beneficial to buy free-range, organic, antibiotic free, hormone free (still get good nutrients from regular eggs)
 - Poultry – may be slightly more beneficial to buy free-range, organic, antibiotic free, hormone free
 - Red meat – may be slightly more beneficial to buy grass-fed, organic, antibiotic free, hormone free
 - Fish – wild-caught reduces exposure to heavy metals
- **ADDITIONAL INFO**



- Sodium needs differ for each swimmer – will be higher than non-athlete peers. May need “high-sodium” foods/supplements near exercise.
 - Low-sodium food: <140 mg per serving
 - Moderate-sodium food: <400 mg per serving
 - High-sodium food: >400 mg per serving
- Calorie recommendations and % Daily Values on packaged foods do not apply to swim athletes
- Look for local
 - Check labels for country/state of origin
 - Local farmer’s markets are a great option
- Watch out for marketing
 - “All Natural” or “100% Real” mean absolutely nothing
 - Don’t rely on front of packaging – take the extra time to read the back
- OTHER INGREDIENTS TO WATCH OUT FOR
 - Partially hydrogenated oils (trans fats) are banned and should no longer be included
 - Artificial sweeteners (sucralose, aspartame, acesulfame potassium, etc.) may cause GI upset in some swimmers
 - Artificial preservatives (such as BHA & BHT)
 - Artificial colors & food dyes
 - Added sugar (in large amounts)

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